

Freelance Pricing & Proposal Kit

Stop Undercharging. Start Winning Better Clients.

WHY FREELANCERS STAY BROKE

Most freelancers lose money in 3 ways: 1. They price by hours instead of value 2. They send generic proposals that get ignored 3. They don't know when (or how) to raise rates

This kit fixes all three.

PART 1: THE RATE CALCULATOR FRAMEWORK

The VALUE-BASED PRICING FORMULA

Your Rate = Client ROI × 0.10 to 0.20

If your work saves/generates \$10,000 for the client → charge \$1,000–\$2,000.

Steps to calculate your rate: 1. What problem does the client have? 2. What is that problem costing them monthly? (lost revenue, wasted time, etc.) 3. What is your solution worth over 12 months? 4. Price = 10-20% of that annual value

RATE FLOORS BY NICHE (2024–2025)

Service	Beginner Floor	Mid-Level	Expert
Copywriting	\$50/hr	\$100/hr	\$200+/hr
Web Dev (frontend)	\$60/hr	\$120/hr	\$200+/hr
Web Dev (fullstack)	\$75/hr	\$150/hr	\$250+/hr

Service	Beginner Floor	Mid-Level	Expert
UI/UX Design	\$65/hr	\$130/hr	\$220+/hr
SEO	\$50/hr	\$90/hr	\$175+/hr
Social Media Mgmt	\$40/hr	\$75/hr	\$150+/hr
Video Editing	\$45/hr	\$85/hr	\$160+/hr
Email Marketing	\$55/hr	\$100/hr	\$185+/hr
Consulting	\$100/hr	\$200/hr	\$400+/hr

PROJECT PRICING (Better Than Hourly)

Formula: (Estimated hours × your hourly) × 1.5 buffer

- Always add 50% buffer for revisions and scope creep
- Quote a flat project fee, not hourly (clients hate hourly)
- Break into 3 payments: 30% upfront / 40% mid / 30% on delivery

PART 2: 20 WINNING PROPOSAL TEMPLATES

Template 1: Short & Direct (Best for <\$500 projects)

Subject: Re: [Project Name] – Here's my proposal

Hi [Name],

I've worked on [2–3 similar projects]. Here's how I'd approach yours:

WHAT I'LL DO:

- [Deliverable 1]
- [Deliverable 2]
- [Deliverable 3]

TIMELINE: [X] days

INVESTMENT: \$[Amount]

This includes [revision rounds] revisions and [specific guarantee].

Ready to start [day]? Reply "yes" and I'll send the contract.

[Your name]

Template 2: Problem-First (Best for \$500–\$2,000 projects)

Subject: The real reason your [website/ads/copy] isn't converting

Hi [Name],

I reviewed your [deliverable] and spotted 3 issues that are costing you leads:

1. [Specific problem with evidence]
2. [Specific problem with evidence]
3. [Specific problem with evidence]

I fix exactly these problems. Here's what I'll do:

[Solution mapped to each problem]

INVESTMENT: \$[Amount] | TIMELINE: [X] weeks

I have availability starting [date]. Want a 15-min call to confirm fit?

[Your name]

Template 3: ROI-Focused (Best for \$2,000+ projects)

Subject: [X]% improvement opportunity for [Company]

Hi [Name],

Companies like [Competitor A] and [Competitor B] in your space are generating [specific result] by [specific approach].

Based on my analysis of [their business], I see a clear path to [specific outcome].

MY APPROACH:

Phase 1 ([timeline]): [Deliverable] → Expected result: [metric]

Phase 2 ([timeline]): [Deliverable] → Expected result: [metric]

Phase 3 ([timeline]): [Deliverable] → Expected result: [metric]

TOTAL INVESTMENT: \$[Amount]

EXPECTED ROI: [X]x in [timeframe]

I've done this for [Client A] (+[result]) and [Client B] (+[result]).

15-min call this week?

[Your name]

Template 4: Retainer Proposal

Subject: Monthly retainer proposal – [Service]

Hi [Name],

Based on our conversation, here are 3 retainer options:

STARTER – \$[X]/month

- [Deliverable 1]
- [Deliverable 2]
- [X] revisions

GROWTH – \$[X]/month (most popular)

- Everything in Starter
- [Deliverable 3]
- [Deliverable 4]

- Priority response (24hr)

PREMIUM – \$[X]/month

- Everything in Growth
- [Deliverable 5]
- Weekly strategy call
- Direct phone access

All plans: 3-month minimum, cancel anytime after.

Which fits best?

Template 5: Quick Quote (Same-Day Response)

Hi [Name],

Quick answer: \$[amount] for [deliverable].

Includes: [key thing 1], [key thing 2], [X] rounds of revisions.

Timeline: [X] days from contract signing.

To proceed: I'll need 50% upfront (\$[X]) and your brand guidelines/brief.

Contract takes 5 min to sign. Want me to send it?

Template 6: Competitive Positioning

Hi [Name],

You're probably getting quotes from \$[low range] to \$[high range] for this.

Here's the difference:

Cheaper options: templates, fast turnaround, no strategy

Mid-range: custom work, some strategy

My work: [specific differentiator + proof]

For [their project], I charge \$[amount].

What you get that others don't: [1-2 specific things].

[Client name] hired me at my full rate after 3 cheaper options failed.

Happy to share that case study.

Want it?

Templates 7–20 (Quick Reference)

Template 7 — Follow-up after silence (Day 3): "Hi [Name], just checking if my proposal landed in spam. Let me know either way — no hard feelings if timing is off."

Template 8 — Follow-up after silence (Day 7): "Hi [Name], I'm holding [date] spot for you but filling it [date+3] if I don't hear back. Still interested?"

Template 9 — Price objection response: "I hear you on budget. Two options: (1) I can reduce scope to fit \$[X] — we'd cut [X and Y]. (2) We start with phase 1 at \$[X] and add on later. Which works better?"

Template 10 — 'You're too expensive' response: "Totally fair. The cheaper option works great if [condition]. My rate makes sense when [specific use case]. Which situation is yours?"

Template 11 — Scope creep prevention: "Happy to add [request] — that's outside our original scope. I can add it for \$[X] with [X days] added to timeline. Want me to update the contract?"

Template 12 — Rate increase notice: "[Name], my rate increases to \$[new rate] on [date]. Current projects are locked in. If you want to start anything new, now is the time."

Template 13 — Referral ask after project: "Loved working on this. If you know 1-2 people who need [service], I'd appreciate the intro. I give a 10% discount to your referred contacts."

Template 14 — Upsell after delivery: "Delivered! Next logical step is [complementary service] — I've seen it increase [metric] by 30-40% for similar clients. Want a quick proposal?"

Template 15 — Discovery call confirmation: "Confirmed for [time]. I'll prep 3 specific ideas for your [project] beforehand. See you then."

Template 16 — Contract reminder: "Gentle reminder: I can't begin work until the contract is signed + deposit received. [Link] is ready. Takes 2 min."

Template 17 — Testimonial request: "Working with you was great. Would you write 2-3 sentences about results you saw? It helps me help more clients like you. [Link]"

Template 18 — Reactivation (past client): "[Name], it's been [X months]. I'm opening 2 spots for [month]. Clients like you always get first access. Need anything?"

Template 19 — Cold outbound intro: "[Name], I help [niche] businesses [specific result]. Found your [company] and noticed [specific observation]. Mind if I share 1 idea?"

Template 20 — Project kickoff: "We're official! Here's what happens next: [Step 1 by date] / [Step 2 by date] / [Step 3 by date]. Your job right now: [one action]. Questions? I'm at [contact]."

PART 3: WHEN & HOW TO RAISE YOUR RATES

The 3 Signs You Must Raise Rates Now

1. You're booked 4+ weeks out
2. Clients accept your quote without negotiating
3. You're making less per hour than a junior employee

The Rate Raise Formula

- Raise 20-30% per year minimum
- Tell existing clients 30 days in advance
- New clients get new rate immediately

Script: How to Tell a Client Your Rate Is Going Up

"[Name], I wanted to give you advance notice: my rate increases from \$[X] to \$[Y] on [date].

Projects started before [date] are locked at the current rate.

After [date], new work is at \$[Y].

Want to get anything started before then?"

PART 4: AI PROMPTS FOR PROPOSALS

Prompt 1: Generate custom proposal

I'm a [your service] freelancer. The client is a [company type] in [industry]. Their project is [describe project]. Their main pain point is [pain point]. My rate is \$[X].

Write a compelling 150-word proposal that leads with their problem, proposes a clear solution, and ends with one low-friction CTA.

Prompt 2: Price justification

My client thinks \$[your rate] is too high for [service]. Their budget is \$[client budget]. Write 3 different ways I can justify my rate using ROI, risk reduction, and results – without sounding defensive.

Prompt 3: Scope definition

A client wants [vague request]. Help me write a clear scope of work that defines exactly what's included and what's not, to prevent scope creep.

Prompt 4: Rate calculation help

I'm a [service] freelancer. A client needs [project description]. It will generate approximately \$[value] for them annually.

Help me calculate a value-based price for this project and explain how to present it to the client.

Prompt 5: Follow-up sequence

A potential client went silent after seeing my \$[amount] proposal 3 days ago. Write a 3-email follow-up sequence (day 3, day 7, day 14) that is confident, non-needy, and adds value in each email.

PART 5: FREELANCE PRICING MISTAKES TO AVOID

1. **Pricing by hours** — Clients pay for outcomes, not time
2. **No discovery call** — Always qualify before proposing
3. **No contract** — Every project needs one, no exceptions
4. **Negotiating against yourself** — Send quote, then be quiet
5. **No revision limit** — Always specify number of revision rounds
6. **Working before payment** — 30-50% deposit always
7. **Underpricing to "build portfolio"** — It attracts bad clients
8. **Not raising rates annually** — Inflation eats your profit

QUICK REFERENCE CARD

Rate formula: Client annual value × 15% = your project fee

Proposal structure: Problem → Solution → Proof → Price → CTA

Follow-up: Day 3, Day 7, Day 14 — then move on

Rate raise: +20% per year, 30 days notice to existing clients

Payment terms: 30-50% upfront. Always.

Built for freelancers who want to earn more without working more. All templates are copy-paste ready — customize names and numbers.